

CHAROTAR UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Master of Business Administration (MBA)

Semester – I, University Examination 2009 – 2010

MB 703 Case Analysis and Presentation

Date: 07/01/2010, Thursday

Time: 01.00 pm – 04.00 pm

Max. Marks: 70

Instructions:

1. This paper contains a case, which carries 70 marks.
2. This is a closed-book examination.

Analyse the following given case.

Room 7

The retreat coordinator announced: "Group D: group leader: Niyi Taiwo; members: Eno Akpan, Marcus Lawson-Jack, Zainab Usman and Ovie Ighodalo – to room 7 please,,"

It was 8.08 p.m. The five left for their group session. They had a long, hard night ahead. They were to spend the rest of the night developing action plans for *Template 4*. Typically, these sessions would start at about 9 p.m. and end any time after 3 a.m. Each group would brain-storm and come up with ideas; then the groups would meet the next day at 9 a.m. to present their ideas to management for consideration.

It was the Annual Management Retreat and for the organization, the most serious season of the year. Members of group D were prepared for the session. They had all rested during the 3 to 6 p.m. break that preceded dinner.

In room 7, Niyi quickly took the seat closest to the air-conditioner and switched it on commenting, "This room is so hot."

"And stuffy..." Eno added. She thought *since this place is hot and stuffy, the room should first be aired before the air-conditioner is switched on*. But she said nothing.

Zainab agreed with Eno, "Yes .. very stuffy."

About 30 minutes after work started Marcus commented, "The air-conditioner does not seem to be working well".

Niyi immediately turned up the cooling dial and as he did, Eno asked him, "Why are you doing that?"

Niyi replied, "We need to be comfortable to work effectively...yes ...we were saying ..."

Ovie thought: *decreasing the temperature won't solve this problem. The temperature is fine – the problem is the ventilation. We should open the windows for a while ...* But he said nothing.

With time, Zainab cleared her throat more frequently. She left the room a first time, a second time, then a third time – each time clutching her chest. After her third exit, Eno asked her, "Are you okay?"

Zainab replied, "We'll soon finish. It's okay".

Close to two hours into the meeting, Zainab was wheezing. She left the room and did not return for about thirty minutes. Ovie muttered to Marcus "May be we should open the windows for a while." Marcus nodded in agreement, then he shrugged.

The meeting went on, Zainab was not contributing much. Eno kept asking her, "Are you okay?" The last time she asked roughly 12.15 a.m.), Zainab couldn't answer because she was coughing and wheezing – but she nodded and looked at her watch as she coughed and wheezed. Niyi turned off the air-conditioner and said, "In a short while we will all start feeling sleepy. Let's move on." Niyi switched on the air-conditioner after about 15 minutes.

At about 1 a.m. Zainab started coughing again. Slowly and with obvious difficulty, she stood up to leave the room. She held her chest as breathing became harder. She stretched out her hand to open the door but couldn't. Marcus quickly opened the door but it was too late. Zainab slumped. The Ventolin inhaler dropped from her hand. Eno ran towards her and held her chin up, again asking, "Zainab, are you sure you are alright?" This time Zainab was shaking her head; the wheezing was worse. The veins of her neck had dilated. Her eyes were bulging as tears streamed down her cheeks. Eno shouted "open the window!" Marcus and Ovie were already opening the windows. Niyi ran out to get help Ovie kept repeating in anger, "I said it! I said it!"

Eno and Marcus accompanied Zainab in the car that took her to the hospital. Niyi and Ovie drove behind them in Ovie's car. At the hospital, Zainab lay in her bed cold and still; her eyes were closed; but the doctor said she would be fine.

They sat quietly in the waiting room. It was Marcus who broke the silence.

"I didn't know she was asthmatic until I saw the inhaler."

Eno turned to Niyi, "It's all your fault Niyi; you and air-conditioners. You know Zainab is asthmatic."

Niyi retorted, "If she was feeling uncomfortable, why didn't she say something? Why didn't you say something?"

"I did", said Eno

"When?" Niyi asked looking bewildered.

"Do you ever listen to anyone? Even Ovie said something", replied Eno.

Marcus intervened, "Please, please. Let's stop this fighting. Please."

Ovie said "I am not asthmatic but I was also feeling very uncomfortable in that room." Marcus said, "I too."

"Then why didn't any of you say something? I thought everyone was fine... and Eno who is now shouting at me had asked Zainab several times if she was fine and she said she was fine," Niyi said.

Eno said with obvious irritation. "I am not shouting at anyone. I was feeling uncomfortable. It was very cold but you kept turning the thing up. It was stuffy. I said it was stuffy; Zainab said it was stuffy; Ovie said it was stuffy. You are meat Niyi; you like cold rooms. It's the same thing at the

office; you always clutch the AC remote control. Again Marcus said, "Please guys, fighting won't solve anything...."

Group D's presentation on TEMPLATE 4 was pedestrian. The Managing Director expressed disappointment saying "the job would have to be redone and the cycle completed in a week. It is unfortunate; this will hold back a lot of things; but the incident was unavoidable." Then he thanked "the members of group D and especially the group leader Niyi, for managing Zainab's condition with ER*efficiency".

Later Eno asked Zainab why she said nothing even when she knew she was getting worse. She replied with tears in her eyes, "I wanted to, but I thought you all were comfortable. I kept telling myself 'Zainab, hold on, it will soon be over.' I kept hoping one of you would say something. I don't like to be the one making others uncomfortable. All my life I've always been the one making everyone in a room uncomfortable...

* Emergency room